

UNIT 4

Peace Education

Comprehensive Summary — All Headings Covered

Course: Citizenship and Transformative Education (CTE 80111)
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4.1 Definition of Key Concepts in Peace Education

4.1.1 What is Peace?

Peace is far more than the absence of war or a ceasefire. It is a comprehensive process involving the abolishment of all forms of violence. Three forms of violence prevent peace from existing:

- Direct or physical violence — the use of physical force: beating, killing, torture, rape, sexual violence, armed conflict, genocide, and terrorism. It requires an immediate relationship between perpetrator and victim.
- Structural or indirect violence — injustices embedded in social, economic, and political systems: poverty, discrimination, unequal access to education and health, racism, sexism, apartheid, and hunger. Assefa (1993) describes it as 'killing without the use of force.' It does not require a direct relationship between perpetrator and victim.
- Cultural or symbolic violence — norms, values, beliefs, and ideologies that justify and perpetuate direct and structural violence, expressed through religion, ideology, language, or science (e.g., glorification of war, inflammatory political speeches).

Peace is therefore defined as the state of harmony and enjoyment where there is no direct, structural, or cultural violence.

Negative vs. Positive Peace

- Negative peace — the absence of direct or physical violence (e.g., a ceasefire).
- Positive peace — the presence of social, economic, and political justice and equality, and the absence of structural and cultural violence. Characterised by harmonious social relations and equal opportunity for all to actualise their potential.

Indicators of Peace

A peaceful society is characterised by:

- Safety and non-violence — all forms of violence are prohibited by law and in practice.
- Fair and effective justice systems — everyone is treated equally under the law.
- Government accountability and citizen participation in political decisions.
- Non-violent conflict resolution and cooperation to improve collective life.
- Fair access to basic needs and equal economic opportunities for all, regardless of identity.

4.1.2 Levels of Peace

Based on levels, peace can be understood as living in harmony with oneself (inner peace), with others (interpersonal and social peace), and with the natural environment (ecological peace).

4.1.3 Peace Education: Many Different Definitions

Peace education is broadly defined as education that promotes a culture of peace — the process of acquiring values, knowledge, attitudes, skills, and behaviours to live harmoniously. Key definitions include:

- UNICEF (1999) — promoting knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values to prevent and resolve conflict non-violently at all levels (intrapersonal, interpersonal, intergroup, national, international).
- Harris (2008) — 'the process of teaching people about the threats of violence and strategies for peace.'

- AEGIS Trust — equipping beneficiaries with practical knowledge and skills to promote peace in their communities.
- REB / PVE (2015, Rwanda) — education promoting social cohesion, positive values such as pluralism, responsibility, and empathy, critical thinking, and action toward a more peaceful society.

The core task of peace education is to transform learners — and through them, society — from a culture of war to a culture of peace, forming responsible, committed, and caring citizens who advocate for peace.

Types of Peace Education: Formal, Non-formal, and Informal

- Formal peace education — takes place in structured classroom settings. In Rwanda, it is integrated into other subjects as a cross-cutting subject (Peace and Values Education / PVE) and is also offered at university level.
- Non-formal peace education — planned, structured discussion forums outside the school system, often called 'home-grown solutions' in Rwanda. Examples include Umugoroba w'ababyeyi, Umuganda, Abunzi, Ingando, Itorero, Ndi Umunyarwanda, genocide memorials, museums, and churches.
- Informal peace education — spontaneous learning through everyday interactions.

Key civil society organisations in Rwanda: Aegis Trust, Never Again Rwanda, IRDP, Wellspring Academy, AEE, CARSA, Rabagirana Ministry, and Amahoro Builders.

4.2 Approaches to Peace Education and Main Components

4.2.1 Major Approaches to Peace Education

Peace education can be approached narrowly (school-focused) or broadly (involving the whole community and society). Schools are effective agents because they reach all children, have resources and authority, engage children during a formative developmental period, and their information is generally accepted as truth by young people.

Two further approaches are distinguished:

- Education for peace — focuses on developing the skills, attitudes, and knowledge needed to create and maintain peace (conflict resolution, non-violence, managing cultural differences). Aims to create peacemakers; often initiated during or after conflict for restoration, reconciliation, and a culture of peace.
- Education about peace — focuses on knowledge and understanding: what peace is, what contributes to or damages it, and one's role in the peace process. Considered 'essential peace education' — without this foundational knowledge, peace cannot be achieved.

Using a farming analogy: education for peace prepares the soil (minds and hearts through attitudes), while education about peace is the seed (knowledge) that grows on the prepared land.

4.2.2 Main Components of Peace Education

Peace education operates across four interrelated domains:

- Cognitive Domain (Knowledge and Understanding) — understanding the nature of conflict, root causes of violence, and peace concepts (positive vs. negative peace).
- Practical Domain (Skills and Capacities) — Nonviolent Communication (NVC), conflict transformation and mediation, critical thinking, media literacy, and cooperation.
- Affective Domain (Attitudes and Values) — respect for self and others, empathy, compassion, open-mindedness, tolerance, and a sense of justice and responsibility.

- Behavioural Domain (Action and Participation) — translating the other three domains into constructive action: personal self-regulation, community engagement, and global citizenship.

The ultimate objective is to create active peacebuilders who are knowledgeable, competent, and morally driven to build a more equitable, sustainable, and peaceful world.

Major Theories of Peace Education

- Peace education for negative peace — addresses direct violence through human rights education, international education (for peacekeeping), character and values education, and conflict resolution education.
- Peace education for positive peace — eliminates structural and cultural violence and fosters justice and well-being, including: (i) Critical peace education — equipping people to identify and eradicate local social injustices; (ii) Postcolonial peace education — challenging structural violence rooted in colonialism that persists in global economics, politics, and social relations.

4.3 Causes of Conflict, Conflict Analysis, and Techniques of Conflict Resolution

4.3.1 The Concept of Conflict

Defining Conflict

Conflict is a clash of interests arising from incompatible goals, needs, values, or the pursuit of scarce resources. Though commonly seen as destructive, conflict is an essential and multidimensional social process. When managed constructively, it promotes positive change; when expressed destructively, it produces violence and lasting damage.

Levels and Types of Conflict

Conflict can occur at five levels: personal/intrapersonal, interpersonal, inter-group/intra-group, intra/inter-organisational, interstate/intrastate, and transnational/global. Types include armed vs. non-armed; military vs. non-military; low, medium, or high intensity; and conflicts classified by cause — political, ideological, identity-based, social, cultural, economic, religious, or ethnic.

Theories About Causes of Conflict

- Community relations theory — conflict caused by ongoing polarisation and hostility between groups.
- Principled negotiation theory — conflict caused by incompatible positions and zero-sum thinking.
- Human needs theory — conflict caused by unmet basic needs: security, identity, recognition, participation, and autonomy.
- Identity theory — conflict caused by threatened identity and unresolved past suffering.
- Intercultural miscommunication theory — conflict caused by incompatibilities in cultural communication styles.
- Conflict transformation theory — conflict caused by structural inequalities and injustices.

Factors Generating Conflicts

Conflict is context-specific, multi-causal, and multi-dimensional. Factors occur at multiple levels:

- Global level — global inequalities, environmental constraints, weapons proliferation, ideological contestation, religious intolerance, and racism.

- Regional level — dependency patterns, inequitable resource access, weak governance, debt burdens, and proliferation of small arms.
- National level — weak political institutions, political exclusion, breakdown of social contract, corruption, identity politics, authoritarian rule, and deep economic inequalities.
- Interpersonal level — personal differences, lack of information, stress, and role incompatibility (conflicting roles).
- Individual level — incomparability of alternatives, unacceptability of options, uncertainty, and stress from role ambiguity or unreasonable workload.

Phases of Conflict: Escalation and De-escalation

- Latent conflict (pre-conflict) — differences exist but are not yet acted upon; any event can trigger escalation.
- Conflict emergence — a triggering event causes the conflict to erupt into the open.
- Escalation — increasing intensity, new parties entering, mounting violence.
- Stalemate (the 'hurting stalemate') — neither side can win nor back down; often the best opportunity for negotiation.
- De-escalation — reduction in tension and violence; possibility of settlement.
- Post-conflict — peacebuilding begins: apology, forgiveness, reconciliation, democratisation, and development to prevent relapse.

4.3.2 Conflict Analysis

Conflict analysis is a systematic study of the profile, causes, actors, and dynamics of a conflict. It is needed to understand background and history, identify all relevant parties, understand their perspectives, identify underlying trends, and help peacebuilding organisations understand their context and role.

Galtung's Conflict Triangle (ABC Triangle)

Johan Galtung's model identifies three interrelated aspects of every conflict: Attitudes (A) of the parties, their Behaviour (B), and the Contradiction (C) — the incompatible goals or values between them. Attitudes and contradictions exist at the latent level; behaviour is the visible evidence. A conflict can start from any one aspect but must involve all three. Resolving conflict requires simultaneous changes in behaviour, attitudes, and underlying structures.

Conflict Mapping and the Conflict Tree

Conflict mapping represents a conflict graphically, placing parties in relation to each other and the problem. The Conflict Tree is a key tool: the roots represent the deep, invisible root causes; the trunk represents the core problem (where all causes converge); and the branches, leaves, and fruits represent the effects. Over time, effects can become new causes, illustrating the self-reproducing complexity of conflicts.

4.3.3 Different Ways of Addressing Conflict

1. Conflict Management

Limits the negative aspects of conflict without eliminating root causes — used when complete resolution is impossible. Five management styles exist, characterised by levels of assertiveness and cooperation:

- Competing (win-lose, high assertiveness/low cooperation) — imposes one party's will. Appropriate in emergencies or when vital issues are at stake.

- Avoiding (lose-lose, low assertiveness/low cooperation) — withdraws from conflict. Appropriate for low-importance issues or when more time is needed.
- Accommodating (lose-win, low assertiveness/high cooperation) — accepts the other's will. Appropriate when one is in the wrong or maintaining goodwill matters more than the outcome.
- Compromising (50/50, moderate assertiveness/cooperation) — seeks mutually acceptable partial solutions. Appropriate when both sides have equally important goals or under time pressure.
- Collaborating (win-win, high assertiveness/high cooperation) — finds a solution satisfying both parties. The most comprehensive style; used when the conflict is important and warrants time and energy.

2. Conflict Settlement

Brings a dispute to an end through negotiation and mediation without necessarily addressing fundamental causes. Often the quickest solution but temporary — underlying structures remain unaddressed. The Versailles Treaty (1919) is a classic example of a settlement that failed to resolve root causes, laying the seeds of World War II.

3. Conflict Resolution

A comprehensive, mutual approach where parties jointly find and guarantee their own solution, seeking a win-win outcome. Requires addressing deep-rooted sources, changing violent behaviours, transforming hostile attitudes, and restructuring exploitative systems. Difficult to achieve in long-standing violent conflicts as parties are often not open to close cooperation.

Techniques of Conflict Resolution

- Conciliation — a neutral conciliator helps parties communicate and reach an amicable agreement. Parties are not legally bound to accept the conciliator's suggestions.
- Negotiation — the most basic technique; parties directly exchange information and interests. The first method of choice, usable at any stage of conflict.
- Mediation — a neutral mediator facilitates communication impartially, helping parties find their own solution. The mediator cannot impose a decision.
- Arbitration — an impartial arbitrator hears evidence and makes a decision; binding if agreed in advance.
- Litigation — use of the formal court system. Involuntary — the defendant must participate; the decision is based on law.

4. Conflict Transformation

Addresses the root causes of conflict by progressively removing the structural conditions that gave rise to it. Includes peacebuilding — strengthening peacekeeping and peacemaking by addressing structural issues and long-term relationships between former adversaries. Requires political, social, economic, and cultural change at all levels.

4.4 Citizenship and Identity: Challenges of Citizenship, Tolerance, and Human Rights Education

4.4.1 Conceptual Foundations

Modern citizenship is a multi-layered status comprising a legal dimension (rights and duties), a political dimension (participation in governance), a social dimension (community membership), and a cultural dimension (shared identity and values). Identity operates at multiple competing levels: personal identity

(individual traits and values), social identity (group memberships), civic identity (relationship to a political community), and hybrid identity (blending multiple cultural influences). A critical challenge arises when different identity layers conflict — for example, when religious beliefs conflict with civic duties.

4.4.2 The Main Obstacles to Modern Citizenship

- The citizenship-inclusion paradox — how to balance national cohesion with respect for diversity, manifesting in assimilation pressures, ghettoisation, and cosmetic multiculturalism.
- Competing loyalties — diaspora citizens, religious citizens, digital citizens, and environmental citizens may feel divided between national obligations and transnational identities.
- The rights-responsibilities imbalance — a trend toward rights inflation, free-riding, and consumer citizenship (expecting state services without fulfilling civic duties).
- Digital citizenship challenges — algorithmic governance, misinformation ecosystems, digital divides, and surveillance citizenship complicating democratic participation.

4.4.3 The Tolerance Education Pedagogy

True tolerance in peace education is not indifference, relativism, or passive endurance. It is the active, engaged recognition of the equal dignity and rights of others despite differences, coupled with commitment to protect those rights even when one disapproves of specific beliefs or practices. Tolerance has evolved from permission (weak) through respect (strong) to engagement (transformative).

Effective tolerance education operates on four levels:

- Cognitive — debunking stereotypes through counter-narratives.
- Affective — building empathy through perspective-taking exercises.
- Behavioural — building cross-group relationships through structured contact.
- Institutional — creating inclusive norms through policy and environment change.

Allport's Contact Hypothesis (1954) requires: equal status, common goals, intergroup cooperation, and institutional support. Pitfalls to avoid include the 'tourist approach' (superficial celebration of difference), paralysis by guilt, the tolerance-of-intolerance paradox, and depoliticised diversity.

4.4.4 Human Rights Education (HRE): Beyond Legalism

HRE rests on three pillars: Learning about rights (knowledge of instruments and mechanisms), learning through rights (operating in a rights-respecting educational environment), and learning for rights (empowerment to defend rights through advocacy and action).

Key debates in HRE:

- Universalism vs. cultural relativism — are human rights truly universal or Western impositions?
- Three generations of rights — civil/political (1st); economic/social/cultural (2nd); solidarity rights including development, environment, and peace (3rd).
- Negative rights (freedom from state interference) vs. positive rights (entitlement to state-provided conditions or resources).

Transformative HRE pedagogy begins with lived experience, focuses on vulnerable groups, develops critical consciousness, and cultivates agency for action.

4.4.5 Integrated Approach: Citizenship, Tolerance, and Human Rights

The three concepts form an interdependence triangle with democratic culture as their shared foundation. Human rights without democracy are aspirations on paper; democracy without human rights can become tyranny of the majority; the rule of law without democracy can be an instrument of

authoritarian control.

Core educational tensions addressed:

- Individual vs. community — addressed through dialogic pedagogy (e.g., debating vaccine mandates).
- Unity vs. diversity — addressed through 'complex solidarity' (e.g., a class constitution protecting both expression and collective well-being).
- Rights vs. responsibilities — addressed through service-learning linked to rights education.

Current case studies: Indigenous-settler reconciliation in Canada ('Treaty citizenship'); digital citizenship in Nordic countries (critical algorithm literacy); post-conflict citizenship in Colombia (transition from victim/perpetrator identities to shared civic identity).

4.4.6 Future Directions and Difficulties

- Planetary citizenship — educating beyond the nation-state in an ecological crisis.
- AI and citizenship — preparing for algorithmic governance and digital personhood.
- Intergenerational justice — citizenship duties toward future generations.
- Neurodiversity and citizenship — rethinking participation for cognitive diversity.
- Post-national solidarity — building civic bonds in increasingly mobile societies.

The ultimate goal is developing cosmopolitan citizens who hold multiple belongings simultaneously, navigate difference with respect and critical engagement, and act with responsibility toward both immediate and distant communities.

4.5 Education for Tolerance and Respect: A Peace and Conflict Perspective

4.5.1 Foundational Concepts: Beyond Superficial Understandings

True tolerance in peace education is active, engaged recognition of others' dignity and rights despite differences — not indifference, relativism, or passive endurance. Respect operates at three levels in peacebuilding:

- Recognition respect — acknowledging others' inherent worth (used in mediation to validate each party's humanity before addressing grievances).
- Appraisal respect — esteeming particular qualities in others (acknowledging courage in former adversaries working for peace).
- Institutional respect — systems and governance structures that dignify all groups.

A critical insight: respect is asymmetric in conflict — parties often demand it while withholding it. Peace education must directly address this asymmetry.

4.5.2 The Peace and Conflict Analysis Framework

A key paradox: conflict, properly engaged, actually strengthens tolerance and respect. Constructive conflict develops cognitive dissonance (challenging simplistic thinking), the necessity of engagement (navigating unavoidable difference), and empathy (understanding why others hold opposing views). South Africa's Truth and Reconciliation Commission is cited as a real-world example of conflict fostering deeper tolerance through principled engagement.

Allport's Contact Hypothesis, reexamined through a peace lens, requires not only equal status, common goals, intergroup cooperation, and institutional support, but also structured conflict processing —

reflection on the historical and political realities behind divisions.

4.5.3 Pedagogical Strategies from Conflict Zones

- The dual narrative approach — presenting conflicting perspectives side-by-side as equally legitimate narratives, not to determine truth but to understand how truth is constructed differently (e.g., Bosnia, Cyprus).
- Difficult dialogue facilitation — a four-phase structured process: (1) creating a safe container; (2) personal storytelling; (3) perspective analysis (mapping interests and shared concerns); (4) forward movement (concrete steps and ongoing commitment).
- Restorative circles — adapting indigenous and restorative justice practices using a talking piece, center piece, guiding questions, and consensus principles. Used in Rwanda through ingando solidarity camps to rebuild social fabric after the genocide.

4.5.4 Addressing Structural Barriers to Tolerance

Adapting Galtung's Violence Triangle, four layers of intolerance require different educational interventions:

- Direct intolerance (hate speech, discrimination) — conflict resolution training and bystander intervention.
- Structural intolerance (systemic exclusion) — critical analysis of institutional policies and advocacy skills.
- Cultural intolerance (dominant narratives, stereotypes) — media literacy and counter-narrative development.
- Epistemic intolerance (dismissal of certain ways of knowing) — intercultural epistemology and validation of multiple knowledge systems.

Power mapping is a key pedagogy tool: students identify an issue, map stakeholders, analyse visible, hidden, and invisible power, and develop counter-power strategies.

4.5.5 Assessment Framework: Measuring Tolerance Capacity

Tolerance is assessed across four dimensions:

- Cognitive — recognising stereotypes, articulating others' perspectives, understanding historical causation.
- Affective — curiosity about differences, managing anger, demonstrating empathy across conflict lines.
- Behavioural — seeking diverse friendships, engaging difficult conversations, collaborating with former adversaries.
- Social — challenging prejudice in peers, refusing dehumanisation, acting as a bridge between divided groups.

Authentic assessment methods include scenario-based assessment (evaluating responses to complex conflict scenarios), portfolio assessment (reflective journals and bridge-building documentation), and social network analysis (tracking cross-group relationship diversity over time).

4.5.6 Context-Specific Applications

- Active conflict zones — principles: do no harm, conflict sensitivity, psychological safety. Strategies include parallel narrative development, shared curriculum elements, and teacher exchange (e.g., Syria).
- Post-conflict settings — a phased approach: Stabilisation (0–2 years, basic trust and trauma-informed practices), Truth-Telling (2–5 years, multiple perspectives and acknowledgment of

harm), Transformation (5+ years, joint projects and institutional reform), as seen in Colombia.

- Peaceful but divided societies — structural tolerance building through curriculum audits, teacher diversity, democratic school governance, and community-school partnerships (e.g., Singapore's National Education program).

4.5.6 Critical Reflections and Limitations

Tolerance education has real limits — it can fail in asymmetric power contexts, cannot justify tolerance of genocide denial or hate speech, can be co-opted as a substitute for justice, and places a psychological burden on minority groups. Alternative frameworks include justice-based education (equity and repair), solidarity education (collective action), and liberation education (empowering marginalised voices).

Teacher preparation is critical, requiring ongoing training in conflict navigation, intercultural competence, historical complexity, emotional regulation, and power awareness — supported through peer networks, reflective communities, and cross-identity mentoring.

4.5.7 Future Directions: Tolerance 2.0

- Digital tolerance education — navigating online hatred and building digital empathy.
- Neurodiversity inclusion — expanding tolerance beyond traditional identity categories.
- Intersectional tolerance — understanding how multiple identities interact.
- Ecological tolerance — respect for non-human life and future generations.
- Generative tolerance — moving beyond coexistence to creative collaboration across differences.

Research priorities: long-term impact studies of tolerance programs in conflict settings; neurobiological correlates of tolerance development; cross-cultural variations in tolerance concepts; comparative effectiveness of different pedagogical approaches.

General Conclusion

From a peace and conflict perspective, education for tolerance and respect is not about creating conflict-free spaces but about developing conflict-competent individuals and communities. The goal is not agreement but the capacity to disagree with respect; not harmony but the skills to navigate discord constructively; not indifference to difference but the ability to encounter it without being divided by it.

The most profound tolerance often emerges not in spite of conflict, but through its engaged and principled navigation. Every conflict — from classroom disputes to ethnic wars — contains within it the potential to deepen human capacity for genuine respect across differences. The educational challenge is to create the conditions where that potential is realised rather than destroyed.